Pablo Álvarez-Aragón

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Contact Information
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Department of Economics, Piazza Scaravilli 2, Bologna

Personal Information
Citizenship: Spanish
Born in 1997

Research Interests

Primary: Development Economics
Secondary: Economic History, Economics of Religion, Family Economics

Academic Appointments

Oct 2025 – **University of Bologna**, Department of Economics
Postdoctoral Researcher
Advisor: Elisabetta de Cao

Education

Sep 2021 – Sep 2025 **University of Namur (CRED)**
Ph.D. in Development Economics
Advisor: Catherine Guirkinger
Jury: Jean-Marie Baland (UNamur), Augustin Bergeron (Harvard), Pauline Rossi (Ecole Polytechnique-CREST)

Sep 2023 – Mar 2024 **Paris School of Economics**
Visiting Scholar
Sponsor: Denis Cogneau

Mar 2025 **Vancouver School of Economics**
Visiting Scholar
Sponsors: Siwan Anderson, Nathan Nunn

2019 – 2021 **UCLouvain**
M.Sc. in Economics, *summa cum laude*

2015 – 2019 **University of Valladolid**
B.A. in Economics

2016 – 2019 **University of Lille**
B.A. in Economics

Publications

Measuring Norms and Enumerator Effects: Survey Method Matters
(with H. Champeaux)
The World Bank Economic Review, 2026

Working Papers

Living for the Lineage: Ancestral Beliefs and the Spiritual Foundations of Fertility in Sub-Saharan Africa

Religious Competition and Educational Inequality in Post-colonial D.R. Congo
(with P. Villar and C. Guirkinger)
Conditionally accepted, Journal of Development Economics

Shaking the Traditional Order: Women's Conversion to New Christian Churches in Sub-Saharan Africa
(with J.-P. Platteau and C. Guirkinger)

It Takes a Lineage: Kinship Structure and Fertility in Sub-Saharan Africa
(with L. Angelini and A. Jolivet)

Selected Work in Progress

Husbands in the Room: The Impact of Joint vs. Women-Only Training on Household Dynamics in Benin
(with C. Guirkinger, A. Jolivet and A. Lulle)

The Invisible Leash: Belief Systems and the Perpetuation of Gender Inequality

A Century of Education in the D.R. Congo: Colonial Origins, Patterns and Dynamics
(with C. Guirkinger and P.Villar)

Islam and the Clan
(with J.-P. Platteau and C. Guirkinger)

Other Writings

Robustness and Replicability in Development Economics (in progress). PI: Jörg Ankel-Peters; co-PIs: Anna Dreber and Magnus Johannesson.

Álvarez-Aragón, P. (2026). "De las grandes a las pequeñas preguntas, y ¿viceversa? Medio siglo de economía del desarrollo a propósito de la traducción de La Gran Divergencia de Kenneth Pomeranz" *Revista Papeles de Relaciones Ecosociales y Cambio Global, Forthcoming*.

Álvarez-Aragón, P., Baland, J.-M., Guirkinger, C., Villar, P. (2025). "L'héritage des Soeurs Catholiques Missionnaires : Effets sur le Capital Humain des Femmes en République Démocratique du Congo." *Revue d'Économie du Développement*.

Álvarez-Aragón, P. (2022). "Lucas Chancel; Unsustainable Inequalities: Social Justice and the Environment." *Revista Papeles de Relaciones Ecosociales y Cambio Global*.

Álvarez-Aragón, P. (2021). "Sobre Los Premios 'Nobel' De Economía." *Revista de Economía Crítica*.

Álvarez-Aragón, P. (2021). "Slobodian, Quinn; Globalists. The End of Empire and the Birth of Neoliberalism." *Revista de Economía Crítica*.

Seminars and Conferences

2027	Culture and Policy Workshop, Stellenbosch University
2026	III Spanish Workshop in Development Economics (Fundación Ramón Areces); Internal Seminar, University of Bologna; ASREC Annual Conference, Chapman University; CSAE Conference, Oxford University; Bristol Applied Economics Meeting; NOVAFRICA Annual Conference
2025	ASREC Conference, University of Macedonia; CRED Workshop, UNamur; Job Market Training, CERDI; II Spanish Workshop in Development Economics (Navarra Center for International Development); IRES Lunch Seminar, UCLouvain; Doctoral Workshop UCLouvain–Namur–USaint-Louis ($\times$2); Vodoun School of Economics, Ouidah; CSAE Conference, Oxford University; Workshop on Cultural Transmission and Persistence, Queen's University Belfast; International Conference in Development Economics (ICDE), Paris Nanterre University
2024	ICDE, Aix-Marseille School of Economics; University of Santiago de Compostela; AFEPOP 2024; EHESS; Casual Friday Development Seminar, Paris School of Economics; Annual Conference of the Spanish Economic Association, University of Salamanca; Atelier Simiand, Paris School of Economics; UCLouvain–Namur–USaint-Louis Doctoral Workshop ($\times$2); Institutions, Culture, and Long-Term Development Conference, CRED; CRED Workshop, UNamur; Development Economics Workshop, Universitat de Barcelona School of Economics
2023	University of Valladolid Internal Seminar; ASREC Conference, Harvard University; UCLouvain–Namur–USaint-Louis Doctoral Workshop; PARSC Conference, African School of Economics; CRED Workshop, UNamur
2022	University of Castilla-La-Mancha; CRED Workshop, UNamur; UCLouvain–Namur–USaint-Louis Doctoral Workshop

Teaching Experience

2024 – 2025	**Economic Tools to Solve Global Challenges** (graduate) UCLouvain & U. Namur Teaching Assistant to Prof. Guilhem Cassan (Namur) and Prof. Amma Panin (UCLouvain)
2022 – 2023	**Applied Econometrics** (graduate) University of Namur Teaching Assistant to Prof. Wouter Gelade, National Bank of Belgium

Research Assistantships

2020 – 2021	Research Assistant to Marcus Biermann, Bielefeld University

2018 – 2019	Research Assistant to Óscar Carpintero, University of Valladolid

Fieldwork and Data Collection

2021 – 2025	Fieldwork in Benin (2025 $\times$2; 2024 $\times$2; 2023; 2021)
2026	Fieldwork in Zambia
2022, 2026	Research assistant supervision

Fellowships and Awards

2026 – 2030	FNRS WELCHANGE 2025 (co-PI) — Women and Religious Conversion, 223,125 €
2025 –	Postdoctoral Fellowship — European Research Council (ERC 2024, COG 101170376)
2025	Scientific Stay Grant — Special Research Fund (FSR), 2,500 €
2024	Robustness and Replicability in Economics (R2E) — German Science Foundation (DFG), Priority Programme "Meta-Rep"
2023	Scientific Stay Grant (FSR-FNRS), 2,500 €
2023 – 2025	Doctoral Fellowship — Fonds National de la Recherche Scientifique (FNRS)
2022 – 2023	Doctoral Fellowship — Special Research Fund (FSR)
2021 – 2022	Doctoral Fellowship — European Research Council (H2020/ERC, StG 759294)
2018 – 2019	Collaboration Fellowship — MINECO, Spanish Government
2017 – 2018	Erasmus+ Mobility Scholarship — European Union

Skills and Languages

Software	Stata, SurveyCTO, KoboToolBox, QGIS, LaTeX, MS Office
Languages	Spanish (native), English (fluent), French (advanced)

Professional Activities and Service

Refereeing	Journal of Development Economics; Journal of Economic Growth; Review of Development Economics; BMJ Public Health
2023	Organizer, Doctoral Workshop in Economics — UNamur, UCLouvain & USaint-Louis

References

Catherine Guirkinger
Full Professor of Economics
University of Namur
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Jean-Marie Baland
Full Professor of Economics
University of Namur
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Jean-Philippe Platteau
Emeritus Professor of Economics
University of Namur
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